

Assignment 03: Mastering the vi Editor

Level: Beginner to Expert Foundation

Scenario: You are now comfortable creating and managing files from the Linux command line. In this assignment, you will learn how to create, edit, search, copy, delete, save, and manage text files using the **vi** editor.

Learning Outcomes

- Open and create files using **vi**.
- Understand command mode, insert mode, and last-line mode.
- Insert, edit, delete, copy, paste, undo, and redo text.
- Search and replace text inside a file.
- Save changes, quit safely, and recover from common beginner mistakes.

Tasks

1. Create a directory named **vi_assignment03**.
2. Inside the directory, create a file named **student_profile.txt** using **vi**.
3. Enter insert mode and write at least eight lines about yourself, your training goal, and three Linux commands you have learned.
4. Save the file and exit from **vi**.
5. Reopen **student_profile.txt** and add a heading at the first line: **Linux Learning Profile**.
6. Move the cursor to different lines using keyboard navigation keys and command-mode movement keys.
7. Delete one complete line and undo the deletion.
8. Copy one line and paste it below another line.
9. Search for the word **Linux** inside the file.
10. Replace one word in the file using a vi search-and-replace command.
11. Create another file named **vi_commands_notes.txt** and write short explanations for these vi commands: **i**, **Esc**, **:w**, **:q**, **:wq**, **:q!**, **dd**, **yy**, **p**, **u**, and **/searchword**.
12. Open both files one by one and verify their contents using **cat** after exiting from **vi**.

Expert-Level Stretch Tasks

- Use line numbers inside **vi** while editing a file.
- Jump directly to the first line, last line, and a specific line number.
- Replace all occurrences of a selected word throughout the file.

- Copy three consecutive lines and paste them at the end of the file.
- Create a small troubleshooting note explaining what to do if you enter the wrong mode or cannot exit from **vi**.